measures that were announced, and our ability to look beyond the currency turmoil to discuss, for instance, the eventual internationalization of the rupee. Looking beyond the immediate problems would also suggest we were not overly pre-occupied with the current volatility. Finally, I wanted set standards for transparency and predictability, transparency through clear communication, and predictability by laying out what we at the RBI intended to do, so that we could be held to it.

My initial statement, which I read out on national TV, is reproduced here almost in its entirety, with only the description of some of the detailed measures dropped.

Statement on Taking Office, 4 September 2013

Good evening. I took charge this afternoon as the 23rd Governor of the Reserve Bank of India. These are not easy times, and the economy faces challenges. At the same time, India is a fundamentally sound economy with a bright future. Our task today is to build a bridge to the future, over the stormy waves produced by global financial markets. I have every confidence we will succeed in doing that. Today I want to articulate some first steps, concrete actions we will take, as well as some intentions to take actions based on plans we will formulate.

Before I turn to specifics, let me repeat what I said on the day I was appointed. The Reserve Bank is a great institution with a tradition of integrity, independence, and professionalism. I congratulate Dr Subbarao on his leadership in guiding the bank through very difficult times, and I look forward to working with the many dedicated employees of the RBI to further some of the important initiatives he started. I have been touched by the warmth with which the RBI staff have welcomed me.